Leave Policy

Version 2.4 | Effective 1 January 2026 | Owner: Head of People

1. Purpose

This policy explains the leave that employees of Acme Services Ltd are entitled to and how to request it. The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. All leave requests are made through the HR portal.

2. Annual Leave

Full-time employees are entitled to 21 working days of paid annual leave per leave year. Leave accrues at 1.75 days per month.

Requests are approved by the line manager, who should respond within three working days. Leave of more than 10 consecutive working days requires at least four weeks' notice. New employees may take annual leave during probation only with their line manager's approval.

3. Carrying Leave Forward

Employees may carry forward a maximum of five unused annual leave days into the next leave year. Carried-forward days must be used by 31 March, after which they are forfeited.

Unused leave above the five-day limit is not paid out, except when employment ends.

4. Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to 14 days of sick leave on full pay in each leave year, followed by up to 14 days on half pay. Employees must notify their line manager before 09:00 on the first day of absence.

A medical certificate is required for any absence of more than two consecutive days. Sick leave cannot be carried forward.

5. Maternity Leave

Female employees are entitled to three months of maternity leave on full pay. Employees should notify the People team at least four weeks before the intended start date, where possible, and provide a medical certificate confirming the expected due date. Annual leave continues to accrue during maternity leave.

6. Paternity Leave

Male employees are entitled to two weeks of paternity leave on full pay. Paternity leave must be taken within three months of the birth or adoption of the child. Employees should give at least two weeks' notice where possible.

7. Compassionate Leave

Up to five working days of paid compassionate leave may be taken on the death of a spouse, child, parent or sibling. Up to two working days may be taken for the death of other close relatives.

Additional time may be taken as annual leave or unpaid leave.

8. Study Leave

After 12 months of service, employees may take up to 10 days of paid study leave per year to sit approved professional or academic examinations. Evidence of registration for the examination must be submitted with the request.

9. Unpaid Leave and Public Holidays

Unpaid leave of up to 30 days may be granted at the discretion of the department head and requires approval from the Head of People.

Acme Services Ltd observes all Kenyan public holidays. A public holiday that falls on a Sunday is observed on the following Monday.